



Matchanese Mall of Asia

Feedback on Design Proposal

Proposed Design - General Feedback



What We Liked

- The design is objectively good
- It feels warm, cozy and inviting
- It makes good use of the overall space
- It feels like a cafe we would like to hang out in

The Core Issue

- The proposed design **does not feel** like Matchanese
- It's not aligned with the style we discussed and any of the provided references

Review of Current Stores

Key Visual Pillars

- Minimalist – Clean, monolithic shapes.
- Stark contrast between white vs. solid green
- Smooth surfaces
- Functional, modern, clean.



Comparison of Current Market

- **All of the Matcha Places** currently in Metro Manila has the same generic cozy cafe template: warm lighting, wooden elements, plants
- This is **not** a style we want to conform with.
- Our goal with Matchanese is to take the **traditional matcha experience** and translate it for a **more modern** audience

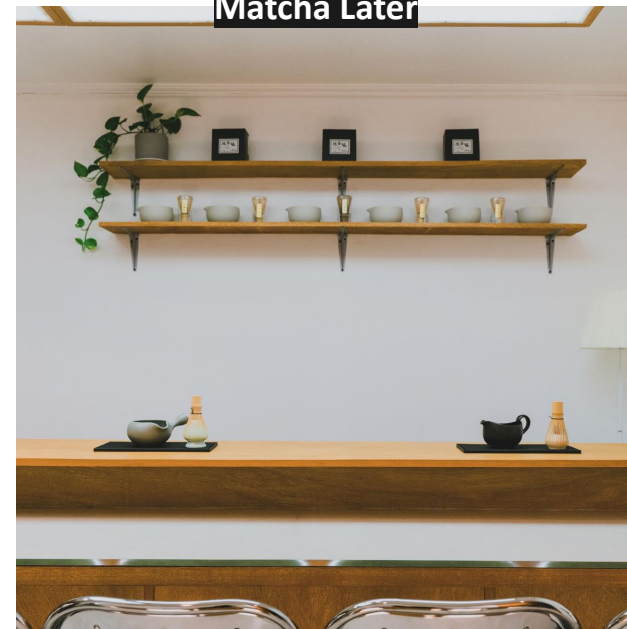
Ujisan Matcha



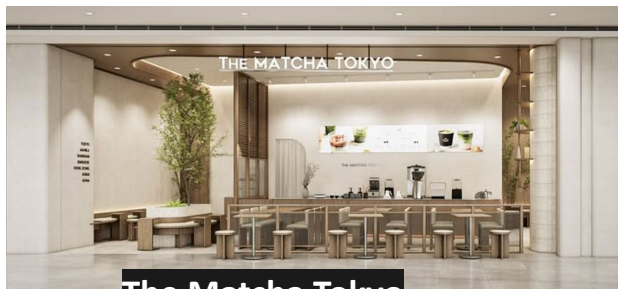
Matcha Bar Makati



Matcha Later



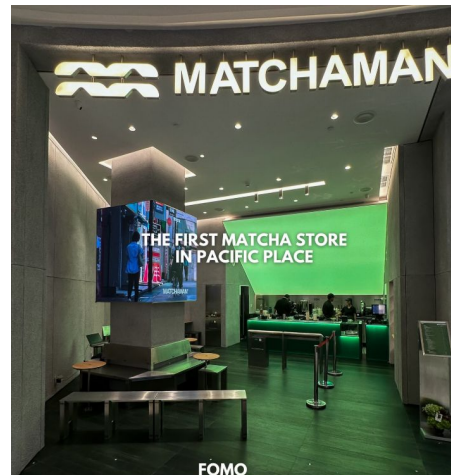
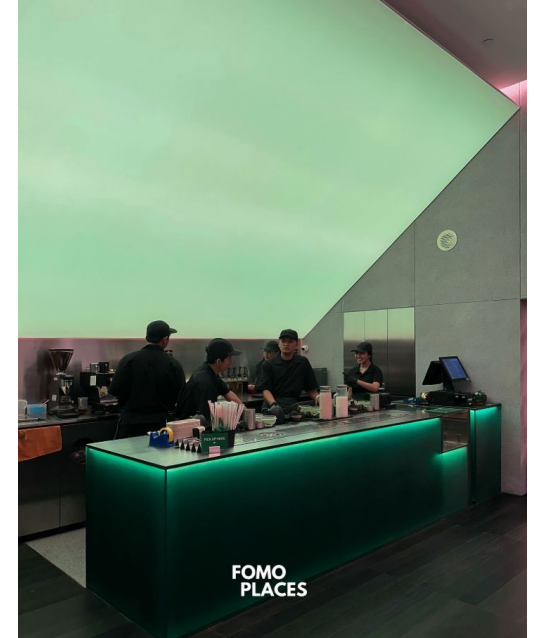
Shizu Matcha



The Matcha Tokyo



Target Direction - Provided Style References



Target Direction - What we wanted to see

- We want Matchanese MOA to be a natural evolution of our current stores
- We want to retain the minimalist foundation:
 - strong, memorable and simple forms
 - contrast of white/neutral elements with green accents

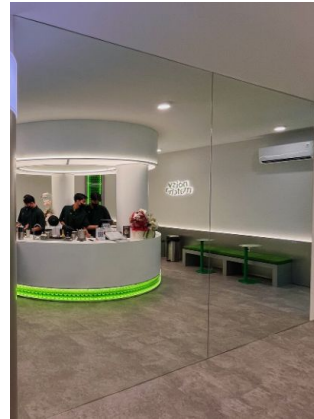
and make it bolder and more modern

Target Direction - What we wanted to see

Replace/Enhance White Elements with



Diffused Lighting



Mirrors

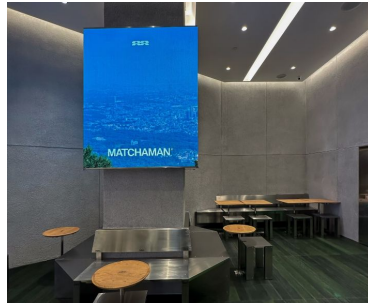
Explore Green Accents with



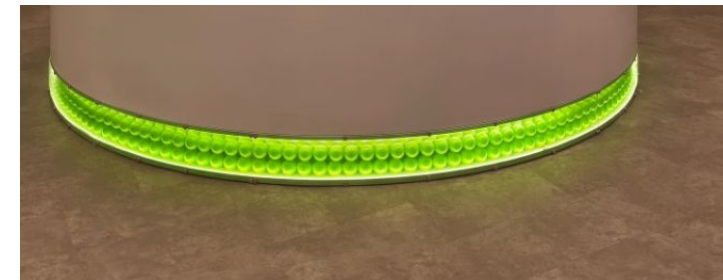
*Lights &
Acrylic Elements*



Furnishing



Concrete and/or Metal



Playful Design Details

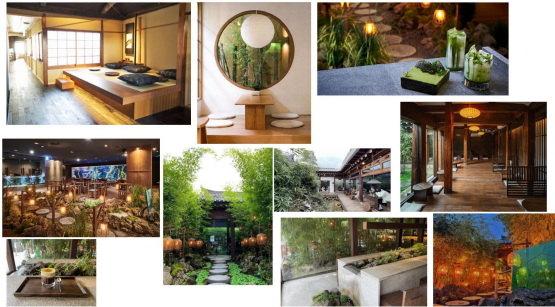
Future Concepts

The reason we want to have a cohesive design language is because we also want to differentiate our Matcha Bar from future flagship concepts that we want to explore



Matcha Bar

Our modern take on matcha. Intended to be franchised as mall kiosks and inline stores. This is our current stores and the upcoming MOA branch.



Matcha Matsuri

A love letter to Machiyas and Traditional Japanese Teahouses. This future flagship will lean heavily on wooden elements and traditional Japanese architecture.



Matcha Midori

A flagship concept as an escape to nature. A space defined by organic forms and environment.



Proposed Design Feedback - Color, Lighting and Feel



- The gradient and texture of the green panel elements look good, however, **the shade of green leans closer to yellow.**
- The overall tone and **lighting evokes warmth**, but that is also something we deliberately want to avoid.

Design Consideration - Color



- One of the things we want to be specific about is the **range of green** we can use because **color is an important indicator of the quality of matcha**.
- High quality matcha is usually a brighter, deeper green color, while lower quality matcha tends to be dull, yellowish or brownish in color
- We represent this in our brand identity which is why **our shade of green is a bold and vibrant green**.
- We are open to explore gradients and different shades and variations of green, but **we want to specifically avoid yellowish or warm tones** to not associate with low quality in matcha.

Design Consideration - Lighting



- The **lighting heavily affects the perceived color of the drinks**, which in turn also **affects the perceived taste**

- Warm lighting makes matcha look more yellowish, which make it appear lower in quality.



- Neutral white lighting shows the matcha's true color, and makes the color pop even more.

Design Consideration - Materials & Textures



- Aside from the lighting, the background materials also affect the perceived look of the products
- Warm surfaces like wood or beige can cast a yellowish tint on the drink, making it look duller or low quality. The grain texture on wood also distracts from the foreground element.
- Smooth and neutral colored surfaces with minimal texture or pattern hide behind the drink and makes the drink stand out.

Design Consideration - Visual Focus

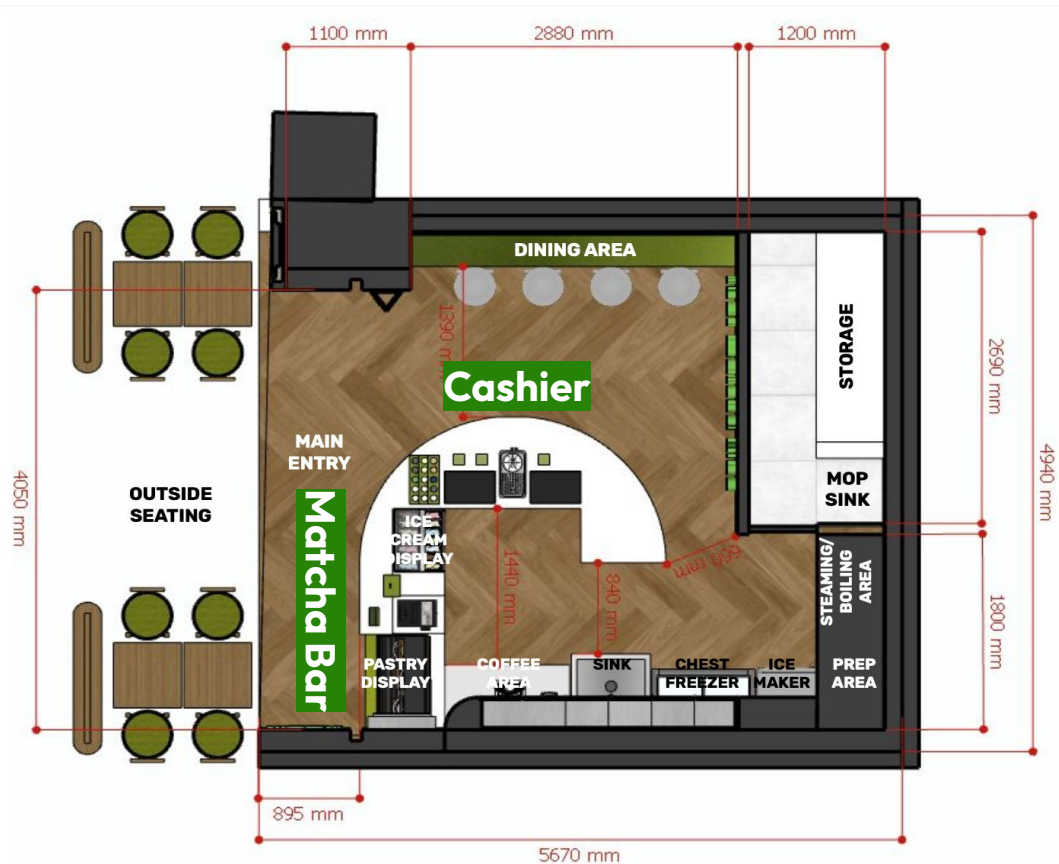


- From the proposed design, it looks **visually busy** – mixed materials, decorative elements, wood, grids, plants, signage and textures all competing for attention making the space look cluttered
- The **product should stand out** when put in front instead of blending into the scene



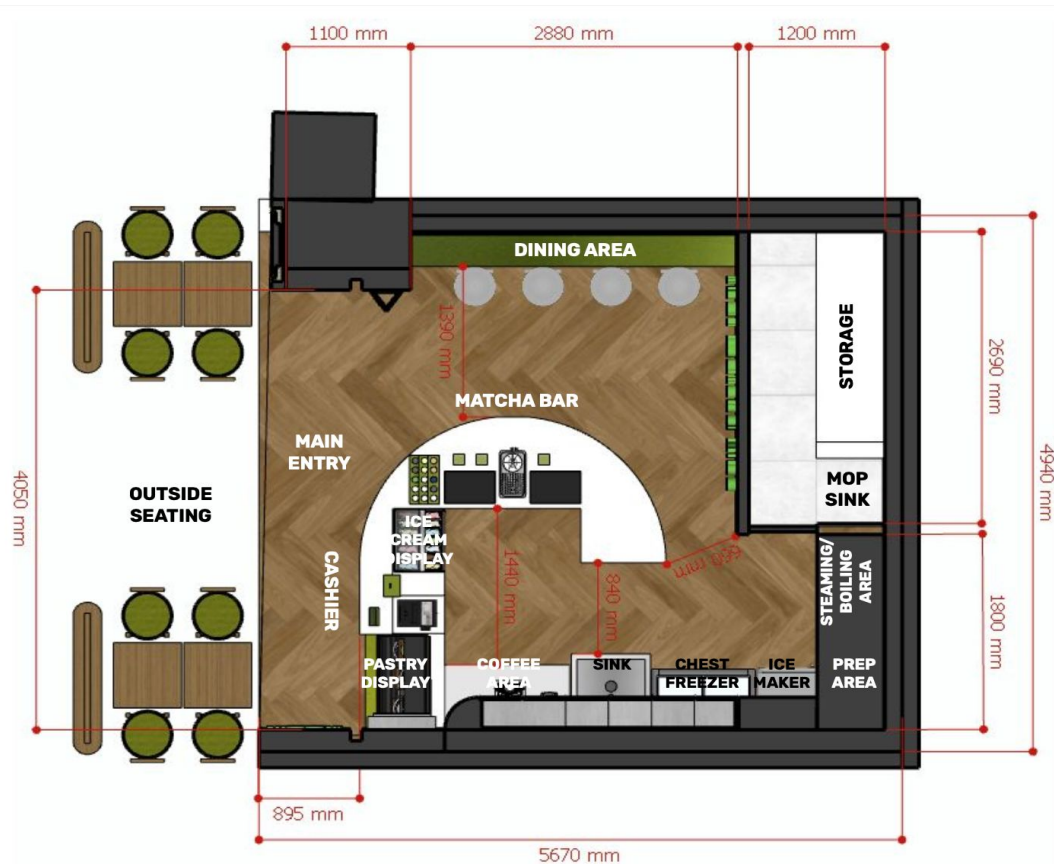
- The layout should have a more cohesive design language and intentional forms with function

Proposed Design Feedback - Layout



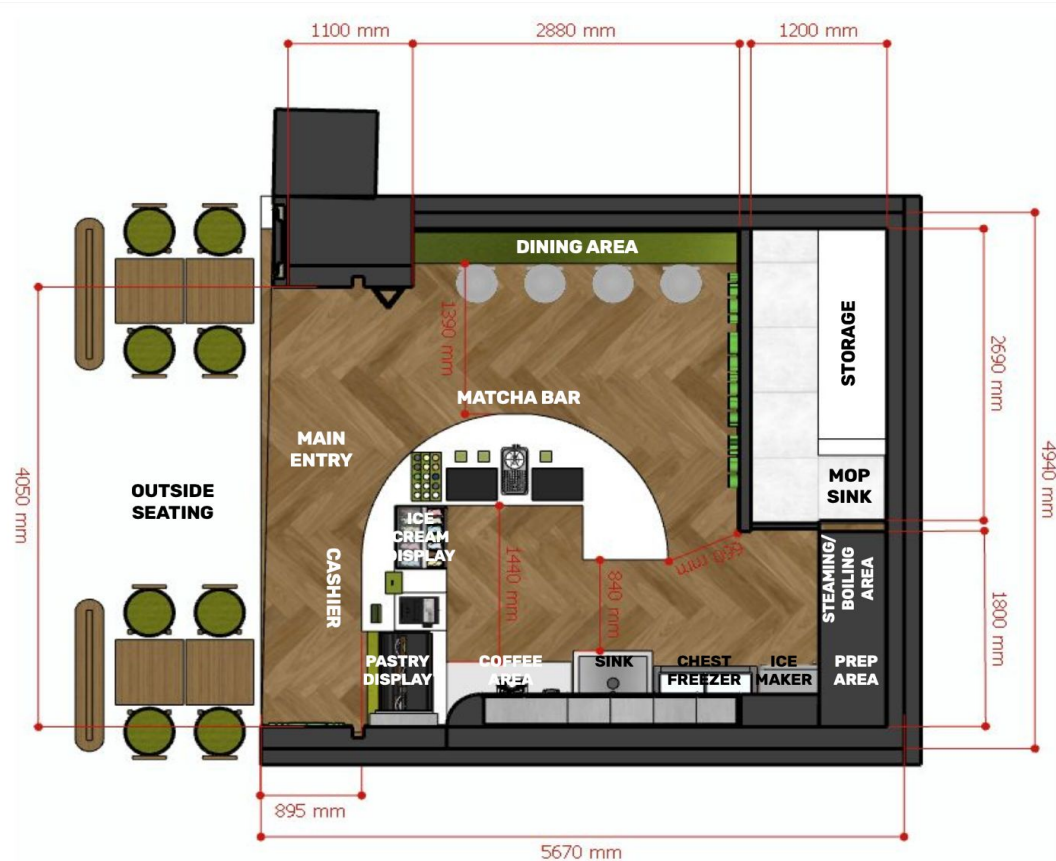
- The Matcha Bar would be better on the front side as it is a showcase of how all our drinks are made. It should be the first thing that passersby from the outside see instead of the cashier
- Since the store opening is in the center, customers queueing up would have a straight line from the outside towards the cashier

Proposed Design Feedback - Layout



- The circular design was initially suggested as it can work when executed well and be a memorable form
- In the proposed design, however, it being a half-circle and hidden inside kind of loses the visual impact.
- A lot of space which could be additional counter space is wasted because of the large curvature.
- From the proposed layout, it might be better to make the the counters more straight and with a smaller corner radius. Also extend it to hide the gap where the staff enters

Proposed Design Feedback - Layout



- The storage area is appreciated, but from the onset it looks like it occupies a considerable chunk of the total space
- The partition wall can be extended so it also covers the cooking area.
- It might also be better to integrate the cooking area with the storage area and have a proper small kitchen

Proposed Design Feedback - Details



- The mirror on the wall is placed well and visually expands the space
- “that matcha vibe” is from an old merch and we do not want to use that tagline here
- The “Now Whisking” feels awkwardly placed and is an unnecessary carryover from our first store

Proposed Design Feedback - Details



- The merch area feels like hidden as an afterthought
- The pick up pointer also feels awkwardly placed. It also usually work when there's a complementing order here sign.

Branding Consideration



Full Logo



Logomark



#1D8A00



Inverted Logo

Because of the logo's reliance on negative space, we no longer use the white version on top of dark background



Gradients – acceptable if within good range of green
Textures – acceptable if minimal pattern



Outdated Layout and Color

Use only either the standalone logomark, or the full horizontal logo

Branding Consideration



The white version of the logo in front of green backing is not advisable as the face of the logomark doesn't register well because of the negative space

The logo is also too big and too close to the top. It should always have even and ample spacing from all sides relative to its background panel.



Recommended treatments

Lighted green built-up acrylic logo with metallic backing or smooth white backing



AI-Generated only

